Vocational Skills Training Implementation Notice

This notice sets out the binding arrangements for delivering the vocational skills training programme during the 2025 cycle. It applies to all training sites, contracted instructors and enrolled trainees, and replaces prior informal guidance. The programme runs for 12 weeks with 24 sessions and 48 teaching hours, and must be delivered within the cost and output envelope recorded in the annexed schedule. Site coordinators are accountable for compliance with every clause below.

1 Programme Scope and Training Objectives

The programme targets practical competency in the designated trade areas and is limited to trainees who meet the entry criteria. Its objectives are to raise measurable skill attainment, reduce workplace error rates and prepare trainees for assessment. Training content must align with the approved curriculum and may not be substituted without written approval. Each site must deliver the full 48 teaching hours and document attendance against the session plan.

Supporting records are presented in Figure 1.



Figure 1: Programme delivery parameters and site allocation

1.1 Delivery Schedule and Site Allocation

Delivery is organised across 4 training sites, each operating the same 12 week schedule to preserve comparability. The schedule fixes 24 sessions per cohort, with no more than two sessions in any single day. Site allocation follows trainee residence and equipment availability; transfers require coordinator approval. Any deviation from the published timetable must be recorded and reported within 2 working days so that central monitoring remains accurate.

1.1.1 Session Planning and Instructor Duties

Instructors must prepare session plans that map each of the 24 sessions to a curriculum unit and an assessment checkpoint. Plans are submitted before the cohort starts and are subject to review within 5 working days. Instructors record attendance, practical observations and remedial actions in the session log. They must also verify that safety briefings precede any equipment use and that trainees sign the attendance register at each session.

Supporting records are presented in Table 1.

1.1.1.1 Practical Demonstration Standards

Duty	Timing	Record	Reviewer
Session plan	Before cohort	Plan file	Coordinator
Attendance	Each session	Register	Coordinator
Demonstration	Per task	Checklist	Second instructor
Feedback	Within window	Assessment record	Assessor

Table 1: Instructor session planning and review duties

Practical demonstrations must follow the approved task checklist and be observed by a second instructor where the task carries safety risk. Each demonstration is scored against defined criteria, and any trainee scoring below the pass threshold receives a documented retake. Demonstrations may not be compressed to recover lost time. Records of demonstration outcomes are retained for audit and must distinguish observed performance from instructor expectation.

1.1.1.2 Assessment and Feedback Cycle

Assessment comprises a mid programme check and a final practical examination, each contributing to the overall result. Feedback is returned within 5 working days of each assessment so trainees can act on it before the next checkpoint. Assessors must use the standard rubric and record evidence for every criterion. Appeals are lodged within 2 working days and are handled by a reviewer not involved in the original assessment.

1.1.2 Attendance and Completion Rules

Trainees must attend at least the minimum number of sessions specified in the cohort agreement to be eligible for completion. Absences are recorded with cause

and may be made up only through approved catch up sessions. Completion certificates are issued after the final assessment and attendance verification. Coordinators reconcile attendance registers against session logs before certifying completion, and unresolved discrepancies are escalated to the programme office.

1.2 Resource and Cost Control

Each site operates within the cost allocation shown in the resource schedule, and expenditure is reviewed monthly against the approved envelope. Equipment, materials and instructor time are the principal cost lines. Sites must report variances promptly and may not commit expenditure beyond their allocation without prior approval. The programme office consolidates site returns and compares them with the planned output and cost profile before releasing the next tranche of funding.

Supporting records are presented in Figure 2.



Figure 2: Cost control checks by site

2 Monitoring, Reporting and Quality Assurance

Monitoring combines site visits, record checks and trainee feedback. The programme office reviews 240 trainee records per cycle to verify attendance, assessment and completion data. Quality assurance focuses on consistency of assessment and adherence to session plans. Findings are graded and tracked to closure, and recurring issues trigger a targeted review. Reports must separate verified observations from inferred causes and must not present correlation as proof of effect.

2.1 Data Collection and Record Keeping

Sites maintain a single register of trainees, sessions, assessments and completions. Data is entered within 2 working days of each event and reconciled monthly. Records must be accurate, legible and retained for the audit period. Personal data is handled according to the privacy rules in the cohort agreement. The programme

office may request extracts at any time and will compare them with site returns to identify gaps.

2.1.1 Performance Indicators and Review Cycle

Performance is tracked through output, cost and balance indicators recorded for each cycle. The review cycle compares actual delivery with the planned profile and documents explanations for variances. Indicators are simulated planning values and are not audited financial statements. Reviewers must state clearly when an indicator reflects observation rather than a causal claim, and must avoid attributing changes to the programme without supporting evidence.

2.1.1.1 Output, Cost and Balance Records

The annexed records show output, cost and balance for the recent cycles. Output rose across the period while cost increased more slowly, producing a widening balance. These figures are simulated planning indicators used for internal comparison only. Reviewers should read them alongside delivery records and must not treat the trend as evidence that the programme caused the change. Any variance explanation requires corroborating site documentation.

Supporting records are presented in Table 2.

Supporting records are presented in Figure 3.

Supporting records are presented in Figure 4.

Cycle	Output	Cost	Balance
2022	81.73	53.12	28.61
2023	91.67	59.59	32.08
2024	102.16	66.40	35.76
2025	120.52	78.34	42.18

Table 2: Simulated output, cost and balance indicators by cycle



Figure 3: Indicator review and variance handling steps

Site coordinators should confirm that the session plan references the correct curriculum unit before the cohort begins, and that any substitution is approved in writing.

Attendance registers must be signed at each session; retrospective entries are not accepted unless supported by a documented make up arrangement.

Instructors should retain practical demonstration checklists with trainee scores so that assessment decisions can be reconstructed during audit.

Where a trainee misses an assessment, the coordinator records the reason and schedules a retake within the published feedback window.

Monthly returns should reconcile trainee numbers with attendance records and flag any unexplained difference for follow up.

The programme office compares site returns with central records and reports discrepancies to the coordinator for correction.

Cost variances should be explained with reference to actual delivery activity rather than assumed causes.

Equipment maintenance logs should be checked before each cohort to confirm that practical sessions can proceed as planned.

Feedback from trainees is collected anonymously and summarised without attributing comments to individuals.

Assessment rubrics must be applied consistently across sites; moderators compare a sample of scored demonstrations each cycle.

Any change to the published timetable should be communicated to trainees promptly and recorded in the monitoring log.

The risk log should be reviewed at each cohort meeting, with new risks added and closed risks marked accordingly.



Figure 4: Reporting responsibilities and submission timeline

2.1.1.2 Variance Review and Corrective Action

Where an indicator deviates from plan, the site coordinator prepares a variance note within 5 working days. The note states the observed deviation, the evidence available and the proposed corrective action. Corrective actions are assigned an owner and a closure date and are tracked in the monitoring log. Actions that require additional expenditure must be approved before commitment, and unresolved variances are reported to the programme board.

2.1.2 Reporting Timelines and Responsibilities

Site coordinators submit monthly returns by the published deadline, and the programme office consolidates them into the cycle report. Instructors supply session and assessment data; coordinators verify it; the office reviews it. Late or incomplete returns are logged and followed up within 2 working days. The cycle report is circulated to the programme board and retained with the supporting records for audit purposes.

2.2 Implementation Risks and Escalation

Principal risks include instructor shortages, equipment failure and low trainee attendance. Each site maintains a risk log and reviews it at every cohort meeting. Risks that threaten delivery of the full 48 teaching hours are escalated immediately to the programme office. Escalation includes the observed issue, its likely impact and the proposed response. The office decides whether to adjust the schedule, reallocate resources or pause the affected cohort.